Conversation track 22, 24, 25

Toan is back from lunch. His coworker Huong has a message from their boss, Diane.

Toan: Hey, Huong. Did Diane call while I was at lunch?

Huong: Yes. She **said** her flight **was** delayed.

Toan: Oh no. What about our meeting at three?

Huong: She **told** me she **couldn't** make it. She **said** we **could** start without her.

Toan: OK. Did she say anything about my report?

Huong: She **said** it **was** really good, but it **needed** more charts.

Toan: More charts? She **told** me it **was** perfect yesterday!

Huong: Don't worry. She **said she'd** call you tonight.

Speak Like a Native track 23

1. She said her flight was delayed.

linking: "said_her" (mất âm h)
weak: "her", "was"
strong: "flight", "delayed"

"her" đọc nhẹ nên mất âm /h/, nối với "said" thành "se-đơ". "was" đọc nhẹ /wəz/. Nhấn vào tin chính: "flight", "delayed".

2. She told me she couldn't make it.

change: "told me", "couldn't make"
linking: "make_it"
strong: "couldn't"

Âm /d/ của "told" và /t/ của "couldn't" gần như mất trước phụ âm: "tôl-mi", "cu-đần-mêi-kit". Nhấn "couldn't" vì đó là tin chính.

3. She said she'd call you tonight.

weak: "she'd"
linking: "call_you"
strong: "call", "tonight"

"she'd" (= she would) đọc /ʃiːd/; âm /d/ rất nhẹ trước "call" nhưng không được bỏ. "call you" nối thành "co-lyo".

• Câu tường thuật có nhiều từ nhẹ (she, her, was); nhấn vào thông tin mới: her FLIGHT was DELAYED.
• "her, him, his" đọc nhẹ thường mất âm /h/: said her → "se-đơ".
• she'd, he'd, they'd (= would) đọc nhanh, âm /d/ rất nhẹ.
• "said" đọc /sed/, vần với "bed"; đừng đọc /seɪd/ như "say" thêm âm d.

Role Play track 27

A: Hey, Huong. Did Diane call while I was at lunch?

B: Yes. She said her flight _____.

A: Oh no. What about our meeting at three?

B: She told me she _____. She said we could start without her.

A: OK. Did she say anything about my report?

B: She said it was really good, but it _____.

A: More charts? She told me it was perfect yesterday!

B: Don't worry. She said she'd call you tonight.

Study Notes

She couldn't make it.
Chị ấy không đến được.
"make it" = đến được, tham dự được (cuộc họp, bữa tiệc…) hoặc đến kịp giờ.
Cách nói tương đương: She couldn't come.

Did she say anything about my report?
Chị ấy có nói gì về bản báo cáo của tôi không?
"say anything about…" dùng để hỏi xem ai đó có nhắc đến chuyện gì không.
Cách nói tương đương: Did she mention my report?

Grammar Focus

Câu tường thuật: lùi thì

Khi kể lại lời người khác bằng said / told, động từ thường lùi một thì: am / is → was, can → could, will → would, need → needed.

She **said** she **was** hungry.
Tom **told** me he **could** fix it.
They **said** they **would** call back.

said hay told?

said (that) + mệnh đề, không cần người nghe. told + người nghe + (that) + mệnh đề. Không nói "said me". Khi nói, "that" thường được bỏ.

He **said** (that) he was busy.
She **told me** she was leaving.
My boss **told us** the office was closing early.

Substitution Drill track 28

1. She said her flight **was delayed**.
   a. was canceled
   b. was two hours late
   c. was overbooked

2. She told me she **couldn't make it**.
   a. wouldn't be back today
   b. was too busy
   c. had another meeting

3. She said it was really good, but it **needed more charts**.
   a. was a little long
   b. had a few typos
   c. needed more examples